ZJU-UIUC INSTITUTE
Zhejiang University-University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Institute
浙江大学伊利诺伊大学厄巴纳香槟校区联合学院

ST 4001
Senior Thesis
at
ZJU-UIUC Institute
AY 2025~2026

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1 General Information

1.1 General Aims

Senior Theses (as **theses**) is an important component of talent development in ZJU-UIUC institute (as ZJUI) and Zhejiang university. It serves as a crucial practical teaching segment in undergraduate education and reflects the quality of college education at Zhejiang University. Its aim is to cultivate students' ability to comprehensively apply the foundational theories, professional knowledge, and basic skills learned during their undergraduate studies to analyze and solve real engineering problems. This has a profound impact on the growth of undergraduate students and their adaptability to societal needs. To effectively serve, support and ensure this aim, to further strengthen the standards and quality management of these, and to continuously improve their quality, ZJUI publishes this document according to the "Implementation on Undergraduate Thesis (Design Projects) at Zhejiang University" (ZJU Policy [2018] No. 3) and other regulations of Zhejiang University regarding theses and in consideration of the practical circumstances at ZJUI.

1.2 General Requirements

Senior theses require ZJUI undergraduate students to independently complete a designated senior thesis project under the guidance of a supervisor and write a thesis that meets a series of specified requirements.

In terms of knowledge requirements, students should integrate knowledge and skills from multiple disciplines to analyze and solve engineering problems, deepening theoretical understanding, expanding knowledge areas, and extending professional skills.

Regarding capability development, students should learn to research, collect, and analyze and organization of scientific literature, correctly cite publications and use reference books, and master fundamental methods for scientific research, and improve the skills of technical writing. They should also master basic experimental methods to enhance their capability to analyze and solve engineering problems in the real world.

In terms of comprehensive quality development, students should cultivate a serious scientific attitude and establish correct engineering, economic, and holistic perspectives.

Senior thesis is handled as an undergraduate course, course code ST 4001, at ZJUI. Students will acquire 2 ZJU academic credits upon satisfying all the requirements of senior theses and passing the course.

1.3 Timetable

Senior theses as a UG course, ST 4001, starts in October and completes in mid-June of each academic year. The detail segments and key milestone due dates of

continuous assessments and thesis submission are listed in Appendix I.

2 Supervisor Qualification

Supervisors should hold high professional and ethnic standards and focus on the development of students' independent research abilities, problem-solving skills, and innovative capabilities in engineering design and basic scientific research. Supervisors should emphasize inspiring students' creativity, encouraging their initiative, and enthusiasm in research and design projects. The supervisors should match one of the following criteria:

1) A supervisor should possess a high level of professional competence and hold a faculty position with at least an intermediate title or equivalent academic rank (including lecturer) at ZJUI.
2) Co-supervisors should possess a high level of professional competence, and hold an academic or research position with at least an intermediate title or equivalent academic rank at Zhejiang University, other prestigious academic institutes, research organization, or industrial corporates that are endorsed by Zhejiang University.
3) The supervisor qualification of undergraduate theses, including ZJUI faculties and those outside ZJUI, will be reviewed and approved by Undergraduate Education Committee (refer as UEC) at ZJUI, and archived by UA office. Supervisors from industrial partners should be reviewed and renewed every three years.

3 Project Assignment

Projects for senior theses should closely align with industrial needs in real world, be oriented towards emerging frontiers of engineering and society, focus on addressing urgent problems faced by industrials and/or enterprises, and emphasize on enhancing students' comprehensive abilities to analyze and solve problems. Interdisciplinary and innovative topics are highly recommended.

3.1 Proposing Thesis Projects

There are several types of senior thesis projects:

1) Research or design projects proposed by supervisors that are within or inter-disciplined of the supervisors' research fields.

Projects should not have more than 1/3 overlap with those of the preceding year from the same supervisor. Faculty should also avoid the topics that are obsolete and/or of little interests or applications in the current industrial fields.

2) Research or design projects proposed by students that are based upon the

proceeding undergraduate research projects of the students.
If the student has completed a SRTP project of national, province or university level or equivalent undergraduate research projects, the student is highly recommended to base senior thesis upon these UG research projects and select the instructor of UG research projects as thesis supervisor. If the supervisor is not a ZJUI faculty, but a ZJU faculty, the project must have a ZJUI faculty as a leading supervisor and ZJU faculty can take the role as co-supervisor.

3) Industrial projects that are appointed by industrial partners of Zhejiang University. The project must have a ZJUI faculty as institute supervisor and main supervisor.

3.2 Project Assignment

3.2.1 Mutual Selection

In general, it is a mutual selection process for both students and supervisors to finalize the topic and proposal of the project for senior thesis. In principle, only one student will be assigned to each project. If the project will be taken by a team, each student in the team should have clear workload, different topic focus and outcome in the project. A detailed description of the work scope and workload should be submitted in advance.

The mutual selection process of project assignment is as follows:

1) Supervisors will submit thesis projects with a title and a brief description to PeopleSoft system before **Oct 17th 2025**.
2) All the projects will be reviewed and approved by UEC at ZJUI. UA office will post the projects to the course of "ST 4001" in PeopleSoft system.
3) Student shall log into PS system and select the three projects with priority rank for ST 4001.
4) Supervisor will assign the project to the students s/he selects.
5) If a student failed to allocate to a thesis project, UA office will inform the student to join the second round of project selection.
6) To ensure the quality of senior theses, each supervisor can instruct no more than six (**6**) thesis projects in one academic year.
7) Once all the students are allocated with thesis projects, both the student and supervisor will be notified of the project assignment by UA office as a kick-off for senior thesis by **Oct 24th 2025**.

3.2.2 Pre-Assignment of thesis projects

Alternatively, a thesis project can be assigned to a student via a pre-assign channel. The pre-assign process of a thesis project is as follows:

1) After discussion between a student and a supervisor, a pre-assign project should be submitted to the institute by the supervisor. The supervisor shall fill up a document (Appendix II: Nomination Form for Senior Thesis Project) with

a title, an abstract (no more than 100 words) of the project and student's information.

2) The pre-assign projects will be reviewed and approved by UEC at ZJUI.
3) UA office will assign the project to the student in PeopleSoft system.
4) Once all the students are allocated with thesis projects, both the student and supervisor will be notified of the project assignment by UA office as a kick-off for senior thesis.
5) If a student wants to take on a thesis project with supervisors outside ZJUI institute, the project shall be submitted via pre-assign channel. The student shall find a ZJUI faculty as main supervisor and the supervisors outside ZJUI institute shall be a co-supervisor. The project shall be submitted by ZJUI supervisor.
6) Pre-assign project with co-supervisor outside ZJUI Institute may not be counted into the six (6) thesis projects of the ZJUI supervisor.

4 Thesis proposal

4.1 Task plan of thesis project

A student should meet her/his supervisor within one (**1**) week after the project is assigned and establish the details of the project according to Appendix III: Task plan of thesis project (refer as "**task**").

4.2 Requirements of thesis proposal

A student should work on a thesis proposal under the instruction of his/her supervisor and write a thesis proposal according to the requirements and the template (Appendix IV) of ZJUI institute. The thesis proposal should include the following parts:

1) A thorough literature review and/or survey of industrial/markets to introduce the current frontier situation and obstacles in the field and to indicate the novelty and significance of the projects.
2) The aims of the project and a detailed elaboration on the approaches/design to achieve the aims with sufficient justifications and validations.
3) The time plan and the expected outcome of the project if it is successfully carried out.
4) Preliminary results and/or current progress of the projects.
5) At least 10 references with no more than 3 citations of websites and no more than 3 citations in Chinese.

4.3 Submission of the proposal document

Students should write a proposal of the thesis project under the guidance of her/his supervisor. After the proposal has been approved by the supervisor, the student should obtain supervisor's signature and submit the thesis proposal as one pdf file to

course blackboard website before **Jan 23rd, 2026**. Thesis proposal submitted on time will receive 10 points.

5 Mid-term check-up

Students will fill up Appendix V: Midterm Self-check Form for Senior Thesis, under the guidance of the supervisor(s) and submit the document to course blackboard website before **March 27th, 2026.** Students will receive 5 points if a mid-term self check form with supervisor signature is submitted to institute on time. ZJUI will organize mid-term check-up on all the thesis projects in the 7th week of Spring semester in the academic year.

According to the self-check form, supervisors should check if the progress of the project is satisfactory, including but not limits to the following aspects, the selection of project, and the management and project progress according to the schedule in "**task**" document.

UA office will conduct random check on the "midterm self-check form for senior thesis" and inform the student and supervisor if a necessary amendment is required. Supervisors should also provide the guidance and comments on project amendments if problems are discovered during mid-term check-up.

6 Senior Theses and Oral Defense

6.1 Senior thesis

6.1.1 Every student should write a senior thesis under the guidance of her/his supervisor(s). The main content of senior thesis, excluding references, should be at least twenty (**20**) pages by following the institute template (Appendix VI: Template of ZJUI Senior Thesis). A senior thesis should include the following parts, but not limited to:

- A title, and an abstract of the project followed by an outline of the written thesis.
- A chapter of literature review and project introduction.
- Chapters of research work, such as experiments, programming, design figures, tests, theoretical reasoning and/or deduction, etc.
- chapters of detail analysis of the research outcome, such as experimental results, software and the testing outcome, design products and testing outcome, etc.
- at least 10 references. Chinese literature should be no more than 3. Website citations should be no more than 3.
- specifications for different types of projects:

a) For research projects, the thesis should include 1) a thorough literature review, 2) substantial research experiments, 2) detail data analysis, 3) sufficient references

and 5) project conclusion.

b) For engineering design projects, the thesis should include thorough 1) literature review, 2) detail design figures, 3) photo and video of the demonstrations on the design products, 4) test methods, results report and analysis of the product, and 5) project conclusion.

c) For software developing projects, the thesis should include thorough 1) literature review, 2) software vendor list, 3) description and manual book of the software, 4) the analytic report of software testing and 5) project conclusion.

6.1.2 Submission of Senior Thesis

a) A student should sign the document of "Academic Integrity Commitment of Senior Thesis "(refer as **commitment**, Appendix VII) and strictly hold academic integrity, match professional standards, respect and protect the legal rights of intellectual properties. Any misconducts and/or violations to academic integrity in senior thesis will be reported to ZJUI UA office and be handled by following the management policy of student misconducts at ZJU-UIUC institute.

b) An electronic copy of thesis draft should be submitted to course blackboard website as one pdf file before **May 22nd, 2026.** Appendix IX: Assessment Form of Senior Thesis (refer as "**assess form**") with supervisor's comments and signature should be attached to the draft. **Committee** will review the thesis draft and decide if the student can enter oral defense.

c) After necessary revision according to Committee comments from oral defense, the final version of senior thesis should be printed double faces in A4 pages and be bundled with other documents according to the checklist in thesis template (Appendix VI). The printed bundle of senior thesis and relevant documents should be submitted to UA office before **June 12th 2026**.

d) An electronic copy of the final version of senior thesis should be submitted to course blackboard website as one pdf file before **June 12th 2026**. The electronic copy of senior thesis should be consistent with the printed copy.

6.2 Oral defense

6.2.1 Oral defense will be organized by UA office at ZJUI on **June 4th, 2026**.

6.2.2 Students and supervisors should attend oral defense in person at the time and location designated by UA office.

6.2.3 Students should prepare PowerPoint slides for oral presentation of thesis project to elaborate the project background, aims, experimental/design approaches, analysis of results/outcome/products and conclusion.

6.2.4 Oral defense of each student will take roughly 20 minutes, including 10 minutes of oral presentation, 5~10 minutes of Q&A.

6.2.5 The secretary of oral defense should record the minutes of oral presentation and Q&A sections in the document of Appendix VIII: On-site minutes of oral defense.

6.2.6 Oral defense will be assessed by thesis committee according to the following criteria in section 6.3. The comments and scores should be recorded in Appendix IX: **Assess Form**.

6.3 Assessment of Senior Thesis

6.3.1 The thesis draft should be reviewed and approved by project supervisor. Thesis supervisor(s) should make a consensus decision if the thesis draft is ready for submission and fill up the comments to Appendix IX: **Assess Form**.

6.3.2 Institute will organize thesis committees according to the research fields and disciplines of the thesis projects. Each committee is formed by 3~5 faculties with one chairman. Each committee will review and evaluate around 15 senior theses. In principle, the supervisor of the thesis should be assigned to the thesis committee that will evaluate the thesis.

6.3.3 The committee will assess the thesis draft and decide if the student can enter the oral defense. A thesis draft will be cross reviewed by at least two **committee** members according to the marking rubrics. A consensus grade will be filled up in the assessment form of Appendix IX: Assessment Form of Senior Thesis.

Note:

- If **Committee** decides that the student cannot enter oral defense, committee chair should submit Appendix IX: **Assess form** to UA office before **June 3rd 2026.**

6.3.4 The components are considered when **committee** assesses a thesis project:

- The overall quality of written thesis, including but not limited to the project selection, workload, completeness, plagiarism level, advance composition, novelty and so on.
- the quality of the PowerPoint slides of oral defense.
- performance in oral defense including demonstration of project and Q&A.
- working performance during the entire project.
- academic discipline and attendance.

6.3.5 Marking rubrics and grades of senior thesis

	Grade	Marking rubrics
excellent	90~100 marks	Students should have completed the project on time and have shown unique opinions and/or novelty on one or several results and/or outcome of the projects. The written thesis has significant aims, completed contents, reliable results and analysis, and a valid conclusion. The thesis is written in high quality and satisfies all the requirements in section 5.1.1., with a good logical flow, a concise and precise writing style, and a correct format following institute template (Appendix VI). Students have demonstrated strong independent working

		capability. And during oral defense, the student can clearly elaborate the scientific and engineering concepts and outcome of the project, and can answer all the questions correctly and concisely
good	80~89 marks	Students should have completed the project on time. The written thesis has complete contents, has no mistakes in results and analysis, and has a valid conclusion. The thesis is written in relatively high quality and satisfies all the requirements in section 5.1.1., with a good logical flow, a concise writing style, and a correct format following institute template (Appendix VI). Students have demonstrated good independent working capability. And during oral defense, the student can demonstrate the scientific and engineering concepts and outcome of the thesis project and can nearly answer all the questions correctly and concisely.
fair	70~79 marks	Students should have completed the project on time. The written thesis has almost complete contents, has no major mistakes in results and analysis, and most of the conclusions is valid. The thesis is written in good quality and satisfies all the requirements in section 5.1.1., with all necessary parts, and a correct format following institute template (Appendix VI). Students have demonstrated reasonable working capability. And during oral defense, the student can roughly explain the project and can answer most of the questions.
qualified	60~69 marks	Students should have completed the project on time. The written thesis has reached an acceptable level with only a few minor mistakes according to the requirements in section 5.1.1. And during oral defense, the student can only explain the outline of the projects and answer some questions incorrectly.
fail	59 marks or below	Students have not completed the project and showed unsatisfied working attitude. The written thesis showed low quality and had a few major mistakes. During oral defense, the student cannot explain the project and answer the questions correctly.

6.3.6 ZJUI encourages students to apply for patents and publications based upon the outcome of thesis projects. If patents and/or publications are accepted by scientific journals or prevailing conference, "outcome scores" will be awarded

accordingly.
NOTE: the scores can **ONLY** be awarded when a thesis project yields qualified outcome.

6.3.7 After oral defense, the chairman of thesis committee will collect the comments and scores from all the committee members and draft a consensus comment. The chairman will fill up the comments and grades in **assess form** (Appendix IX) and sign the document. The assess form should be submitted to UA office with 3 days after oral defense.

6.3.8 If a student receives a "fail" grade in senior thesis, the student will get a "F" in ST 4001 and should not proceed to graduation. The student should retake ST 4001 in the next academic year.

6.4 Plagiarism checks of senior thesis

ZJUI will be responsible for organizing and implementing the plagiarism check of Senior theses according to the requirements, generating a plagiarism check report to assist in academic integrity management. The plagiarism check uses technical means to conduct an initial screening of the thesis quality. The plagiarism check report and the plagiarism rate are the main basis to determine whether the thesis meets the standards for submission. The content to be checked includes abstracts, main content, and references. Senior thesis will be processed according to plagiarism report and rate as follows:

1. Plagiarism rate below 10% is considered passed, with appropriate modifications based on the check report;
2. Plagiarism rate between 10%-20% is considered passed after modification and the student can proceed to oral defense upon further review by thesis committee;
3. Plagiarism rate above 20% is considered not passed, requiring major modifications and a second plagiarism check;
4. If the plagiarism rate does not meet the requirements, student can file an appeal with a written explanation approved by supervisor. **Committee** will review the appeal document and decide if the thesis can proceed to the thesis review.
5. Theses that do not pass the second plagiarism check cannot proceed to the following steps of thesis review and oral defense.

7 Requirements on the students in senior thesis

7.1 Kick-off the thesis project

7.1.1 A student is encouraged to meet potential supervisors and discuss the project before applying for the project, especially in the case that the student would like to propose a project by himself/herself.

7.1.2 A student should log into PeopleSoft system to select and rank three projects before **October 24th, 2025.**

7.1.3 A student should meet all the supervisors of his/her project within one (1) week after the project is assigned by UA office.

7.1.4 Student will fill up "**task**" document with his/her supervisor during the kick-off meeting. Students should work according to the plan and time schedule listed in the document. At the end of the project, students should bundle the document to the thesis and submit the document to institute along with other thesis documents.

7.1.5 Student should write a project proposal according to the requirements in section 4 and submit the proposal to course blackboard website by **Jan 23rd, 2026**.

7.2 During the process of the thesis project

7.2.1 Student should meet the supervisor and co-supervisor if applicable, on regular basis and at least 0.5 hour per week to report and discuss the project progress.

7.2.2 Student should record daily work activities and outcome of the experiments, programming, tests, analysis of the results, etc. on lab notebook.

7.2.3 A student should follow the instruction and guidance of the supervisor and complete the research work and documents of thesis project on due course.

7.2.4 A student should attend all the thesis activities. If a student would be absent to thesis activities, the student needs to seek leave approval from both supervisor and institute via online application. If a student is absence without leave approval more than 1/3 of the project's duration, the student is not allowed to enter thesis defense and course grade will be recorded as "0" mark.

7.2.5 A student should complete all the oral and written reports of senior thesis under the instruction of project supervisor(s).

7.2.6 A student should participate in the mid-term check-up of thesis projects. A student should discuss the project progress and fill up the "midterm self-check form for senior thesis" (Appendix V) together with her/his supervisor(s) and submit the form to UA office for random check by **March 27th, 2026**.

7.3 Requirements for senior theses and oral defense

7.3.1 Students should write a thesis under the guidance of her/his supervisor(s). The thesis should be written by following the instructions in section 6.1 and institute template (Appendix VI).

7.3.2 Students should submit an electronic copy of thesis draft according to section 6 before **May 22nd 2026**.

7.3.3 Upon approval by the thesis committee, students should attend the oral defense of senior thesis and satisfied with the requirements of oral defense listed in

section 6.2.

7.3.4 After oral defense, students should prepare the thesis bundle book containing all the documents related to thesis and an electronic copy of thesis book by following the instruction in section 9. The printed book should be submitted to the thesis book to the institute office and the electronic copy should be uploaded to course blackboard website before **June 12th, 2026**.

8 Requirements For the Supervisors

8.1 Propose thesis projects

8.1.1 Supervisors should propose projects closely aligning with industrial needs in the real world, be oriented towards emerging frontiers of engineering and society, focus on addressing urgent problems faced by enterprises, and emphasize on enhancing students' comprehensive abilities to analyze and solve problems. Interdisciplinary and innovative topics are highly recommended.

8.1.2 Supervisors should not reuse more than 1/3 of the projects she/he supervised in the preceding years.

8.1.3 Supervisors should avoid the projects that are obsoleted and/or of little interests or applications in the current industrial fields.

8.1.4 Supervisors cannot take on more than six (**6**) projects in one academic year.

8.2 Project proposal

8.2.1 Supervisors should meet the students within one (1) week the project assignment is announced by UA office.

8.2.2 During the meeting, supervisor should fill up "**task**" document with the student that includes the details of the requirements for the project and the time table of the project.

8.2.3 If the project has a co-supervisor outside ZJUI, the ZJUI supervisor should liaise all the co-supervisors to fill up the "**task**" document with the student and arrange the student to meet all the co-supervisors within one (1) week after the project assignment is announced by UA office.

8.2.4 Supervisors should instruct and guide the student to conduct a thorough literature review on the research field of the project and to write a project proposal.

8.2.5 Supervisors will be assigned to one or a few theses committees according to the major and research fields of the projects.

8.3 During the progress of thesis projects

8.3.1 Supervisor should meet the student at least once a week for at least half an hour to check the lab notebook and discuss the progress of theses project.

8.3.2 Supervisor should provide sufficient instruction and guidance to lead the student to complete the theses project on time.

8.3.3 Supervisor should ensure the students submit all the written reports and attend oral assessments on time.

8.4 Requirements for midterm evaluation

8.4.1 Supervisor should review the project progress with students and provide the instructions on the amendments of the project if any problem is discovered.

8.4.2 Supervisor should instruct the student to fill up the document of "midterm self-check form" (Appendix V) and urge the student to submit the form to course blackboard website on time.

8.5 Requirements for theses and oral defense

8.5.1 Supervisors should instruct the student to write a senior thesis according to the institute requirements listed in section 6.1. Supervisor should review the senior thesis of his/her mentee and provide sufficient comments and suggestions for revisions.

8.5.2 Supervisor should assess her/his mentee's thesis by following the marking rubrics in section 6.3.4 that requires a thorough review on the quality of the thesis, including the completion level, outcome quality, the work capability, and attitudes of the students, etc. Supervisor should provide comments and sign **Assess Form (**Appendix IX). The student will submit the form along with thesis draft for **committee** to review and to decide if the student can proceed to oral defense.

8.5.3 Supervisors as a committee member or chairman should attend the oral defense of the students assigned by institute and evaluate the students' oral defenses according to the marking rubrics in section 6.3. If a supervisor serves as a committee chairman, she/he should consolidate the grades and comments on both the theses and oral defense of the student from all the committee members to provide a consensus grade and a written comment in **Assess Form** (Appendix IX).

9 Archive and confidential control of senior thesis

9.1 Thesis Archive

Students should submit all the documents, products and materials that are related to senior thesis to ZJUI institute for archives. The duration of archives is no shorter than five (5) years. Students should submit the following two copies of senior thesis before **June 12th 2026**.

9.1.1 A printed copy

Students should prepare a printed bundle of senior thesis (refer as **thesis book**). All the thesis documents should be bundled by following the order in the thesis template (Appendix VI):

cover page → checklist → "**commitment**" → acknowledgement → abstract → content table (including page numbers) → written thesis (page number starting from 1) → references → appendix (acceptance letter of publication, cover page if applicable, publication full text, patent letter, etc.) → author CV → "**task**" → "**assess form of senior thesis**" → "**defense minutes**" document.
Printing format: Content table, written thesis, references and appendix should be double faces. The rest part of bundle should be single face.

9.1.2 An electronic copy

After oral defense, student should upload an electronic copy of **thesis book** to course blackboard website as a single pdf file. Documents for progress records, such as checklist, **commitment**, **task**, assess forms of thesis, defense minutes, are not required for the electronic copy.

9.2 Confidential control

9.2.1 For thesis project are under confidential control, all involved personnel including student, supervisor(s), reviewers, and thesis committee, should sign a document: Appendix X – ZJUI Compact on Confidential Control of Senior Thesis. Compact will be kept by UA office within the confidential duration.

9.2.2 **Thesis book** should be stamped with "confidential" at the right up corner on the front page.

9.2.3 **Thesis book** should indicate the duration of confidential control on the front page. Once confidential control expires, the senior thesis will be handled as a regular thesis.

10 Funding management

10.1. ZJUI institute provides 500 RMB to each thesis project.

10.2. The funding of each thesis project will be assigned to ZJUI supervisor of the project and is the supervisor's responsibility for proper management.

10.3. The funding can be used for printing **thesis book** and other related documents, purchasing experimental consumables, paying for testing charges, etc., upon supervisor's approval.

Fall - Winter 2025-2026 Academic Calendar of International Campus, Zhejiang University

Jan 23
Due Project Proposal

	Summer Vacation							Fall and Winter Semester																	S.S.	
	July	August				September					October				November				December					January		
	Summer Vacation							1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	1	2
Monday	28	4	11	18	25	1	8	15	22	29	6	13	20	27	3	10	17	24	1	8	15	22	29	5	12	19
Tuesday	29	5	12	19	26	2	9	16	23	30	7	14	21	28	4	11	18	25	2	9	16	23	30	6	13	20
Wednesday	30	6	13	20	27	3	10	17	24	1	8	15	22	29	5	12	19	26	3	10	17	24	31	7	14	21
Thursday	31	7	14	21	28	4	11	18	25	2	9	16	23	30	6	13	20	27	4	11	18	25	1	8	15	22
Friday	1	8	15	22	29	5	12	19	26	3	10	17	24	31	7	14	21	28	5	12	19	26	2	9	16	23
Saturday	2	9	16	23	30	6	13	20	27	4	11	18	25	1	8	15	22	29	6	13	20	27	3	10	17	24
Sunday	3	10	17	24	31	7	14	21	28	5	12	19	26	2	9	16	23	30	7	14	21	28	4	11	18	25

Oct 25 – Dec 26
Project Proposal

Oct 17
Submit projects to PS

Oct 24
Confirm project assignment

Spring-Summer 2025-2026 Academic Calendar of International Campus, Zhejiang University

June 3
decision on thesis review

	Winter Vacation					Spring and Summer Semeter														Summer Vacation						
		February				March					April				May					June				July		
	Winter Vacation					3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	Summer Vacation						
Monday	26	2	9	16	23	2	9	16	23	30	6	13	20	27	4	11	18	25	1	8	15	22	29	6	13	20
Tuesday	27	3	10	17	24	3	10	17	24	31	7	14	21	28	5	12	19	26	2	9	16	23	30	7	14	21
Wednesday	28	4	11	18	25	4	11	18	25	1	8	15	22	29	6	13	20	27	3	10	17	24	1	8	15	22
Thursday	29	5	12	19	26	5	12	19	26	2	9	16	23	30	7	14	21	28	4	11	18	25	2	9	16	23
Friday	30	6	13	20	27	6	13	20	27	3	10	17	24	1	8	15	22	29	5	12	19	26	3	10	17	24
Saturday	31	7	14	21	28	7	14	21	28	4	11	18	25	2	9	16	23	30	6	13	20	27	4	11	18	25
Sunday	1	8	15	22	1	8	15	22	29	5	12	19	26	3	10	17	24	31	7	14	21	28	5	12	19	26

Jan 12 – March 27
First half

March 30 – May 22
second half

March 27
Due midterm self check form

May 22
Due thesis draft
for review and plagiarism check

June 4~5
oral defense

June 8
Return thesis grades to UA

Appendix II

Nomination Form for Senior Thesis Project

Project Title (< 20 words):	
Brief description of the project (including aims and contents, no more than 100 words):	
Student's Name & Signature (optional if the project is proposed by supervisors):	**Student ID:**
Supervisor's Name & Signature: **Date:**	**Co-Supervisor's Name & Signature:** **Date:**

Appendix III

Task Plan of Thesis Project

Project Title:		
Progress Timeline: (From Oct 18th 2025 to May 22nd 2026)		
Task details of thesis project:		
Supervisor Name & Signature:		**Date:**

Appendix IV

ZJU-UIUC INSTITUTE
Zhejiang University-University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Institute
浙江大学伊利诺伊大学厄巴纳香槟校区联合学院

Literature Review
&
Project Proposal
for
ST 4001
Senior Thesis

Thesis Title _____

Student Name _____

Student ZJU ID _____

Major _____

Supervisor name & Signature* _____

* Supervisor shall sign the proposal if s/he approves the student to submit the proposal to institute.

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2.1 Research direction and current progress in the field....3
2.2 Existing Problems and/or Obstacles....3
3 Prospectives in the research field....3

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1.1 Introduction to the research fields (Section Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 14) 4
1.2 Aim and Significance of the proposal....4
2. Proposed Research Approaches....4
2.1 Major research approaches....4
2.2 Techniques and Methodology....4
2.3 Feasibility analysis....4
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4. Research Progress....5
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References

Literature Review

1 Introduction

(Chapter Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 18)

Main content : xxx(Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace)

1.1 Xxx (Section Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 14)

Main content : xxx xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx.[1] (Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

1.1.1 (Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace)

2 Current Research Fields

2.1 Research direction and current progress in the field

2.2 Existing Problems and/or Obstacles

2.2.1 xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx (Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace)

3 Prospectives in the research field

Project Proposal

1. Research Background

(Chapter Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 16)

Main content : xxx(Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace)

1.1 Introduction to the research fields (Section Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 14)

Main content: xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx.[1] (Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

1.1.1 xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx (Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace)

1.2 Aim and Significance of the proposal

2. Proposed Research Approaches

2.1 Major research approaches

2.2 Techniques and Methodology

2.3 Feasibility analysis

2.3.1 xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx (Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace)

3. Project schedule and Expected Outcome

3.1 Research schedule

3.2 Expected outcome

4. Research Progress

4.1 Preliminary results

Main content: xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx.[1] (Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

References

(The reference list should be placed after the main text, in Times New Roman, size 12, with single line spacing, and start on a new page. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

[1] ENGEL P A. Impact Wear of Materials[M]. 2nd ed. New York: Elsevier, 1986. (Published books: should give authors, title of the book, edition, publisher, publish year and the page cited if applicable.)

[2] Hao, Z., AghaKouchak, A., Nakhjiri, N. & Farahmand, A. Global Integrated Drought Monitoring and Prediction System (GIDMaPS) data sets. figshare http://dx.doi.org/10.6084/m9.figshare.853801 (2014). (research datasets: Research datasets may be cited in the reference list if they have been assigned digital object identifiers (DOIs) and include authors, title, publisher (repository name), identifier (DOI expressed as a URL).)

[3] Babichev, S. A., Ries, J. & Lvovsky, A. I. Quantum scissors: teleportation of single-mode optical states by means of a nonlocal single photon. Preprint at http://arXiv.org/quant-ph/0208066 (2002). (Recognized preprints may be cited in the reference list.)

[4] Yu, X., Li, C., Wang, Z., Xu, Y., Shao, S., Shao, F., Wang, H., & Liu, J. Neutrophils in cancer: dual roles through intercellular interactions. *Oncogene*, **2024**, 43(11), 1-15 (published journal papers or conference abstracts: should give authors, article title and journal name as above, followed by URL in full - or DOI if known - and the year of publication in parentheses.)

[5] Lu, Q. et. al. www.bing.com (Websites: should give authors if known, title of cited page, URL in full, and year of posting in parentheses.)

[6] Hilderbran, S., Weissleder, R., and **Shao, F.**, Monofunctional carbocyanine dyes for in vivo and in vitro imaging, US Patent No. WO 2010054330, May, 2010 (numbered patents: should give authors, patent title and patent number and country)

[7] Wang Y., Zhang Q., Qin M., et.al Knowledge-aware Reinforced Language Models for Protein Directed Evolution *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning*, PMLR 235:52260-52273, 2024. (conference paper: should give authors, Title of contribution [Paper presentation]. conference Name, Location, Year, Date. DOI or URL)

Appendix V

Midterm Self-check Form

Student Name:		**ZJU ID**		**Major**	
Supervisor		**Academic Title**			
Project Title					

Tasks Completed	Description （Statement of thesis progress, No more/less than 500 word）	
	Compliance with Task Schedule as per Project Plan (To be filled by the Supervisor (Y/N))	
Task(s) to be completed		

Problems and Solutions			
Supervisor signature		Date	

Confidential thesis ☐

浙江大学

Zhejiang University-University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Institute

Undergraduate Thesis (Design)

Thesis Title _____

Student Name _____

Student ID _____

Supervisor _____

Class of year _____

Major _____

Submission date _____

Content Checklist

(Student should bind this form on the first page of the thesis after the cover page. The form should be filled out by the supervisor after the oral defense.)

Student Name		ZJU ID		Major	
Supervisor			Academic Title		
Thesis title					

Content Checklist		Evaluation Section（√）	
Senior Thesis	1 . Cover (Use the unified cover, blue recommended)	Good	Fair
	2 . Academic integrity Commitment of Senior Thesis		
	3. Acknowledgements		
	4 . Abstract		
	5 . Table of Contents		
	6 . Main Content (Page numbers start from the main text)		
	7 . Reference		
	8 . Appendix（if need）		
	9. Author's Biography		
	10. Task plan of senior thesis		
	11. Assessment Form of senior thesis		
	12. On-site Minutes Form of Oral Defense		

Signature of Supervisor:	Date:

ZJU-UIUC INSTITUTE
Zhejiang University-University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Institute
浙江大学伊利诺伊大学厄巴纳香槟校区联合学院

Academic integrity Commitment of Senior Thesis

1. I solemnly promise that the submitted thesis has been completed under the guidance of my supervisor in strict accordance with the relevant regulations of the university and the college.

2. In my thesis, except for the parts specifically marked and acknowledged, it does not contain research results that have been published or written by others, nor does it contain materials used to obtain degrees or certificates from Zhejiang University or other educational institutions.

3. Any contributions made by my colleagues to this research have been clearly stated and acknowledged in the thesis.

4. I promise that there has been no fabrication of data in the process of completing the thesis.

5. If there is any infringement of intellectual property rights in this thesis, I shall bear the corresponding legal responsibilities.

6. I fully understand that Zhejiang University has the right to retain and submit copies and disks of this thesis (design) to relevant departments or agencies, and to allow the thesis (design) to be consulted and borrowed. I authorize Zhejiang University to include all or part of this thesis (design) in relevant databases for retrieval and dissemination, and to save and compile this thesis (design) by means of photocopying, reduction, or scanning.

Author's Signature: Supervisor's Signature:

Date: Date:

Acknowledgements

(Times New Roman, size 24, start in a new page)

(main text: Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

××××××

Abstract

(Times New Roman, size 24, start in a new page, no more than 300 words)

(main text: Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

××
××
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××××××××××××××××

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Chapter 1. Introduction

(Chapter Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 18)

1.1 Section Title

(Section Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 14)

(main text: Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

××

1.1.1 (sub-Section Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 12)

(main text: Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

××

1.1.2 (sub-Section Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 12)

(main text: Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

××

Chapter 2. Title of Chapter 2

2.1 Section Title

(Section Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 14)

(main text: Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

××××××

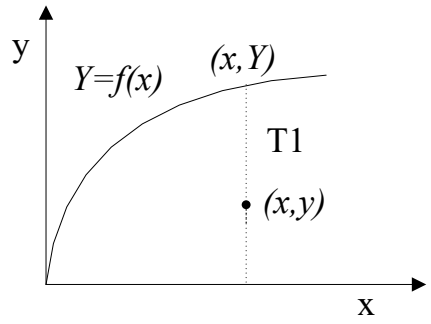

Figure 2.1 ×××××××××××(**Figure XX** (bold) figure captions:Times New Roman, size 12, single linespace)

$$EQI = \sum_{i=1}^{n} Wj * rij \quad (2\text{-}1)$$

$$EHI = L_1 \times ESI + L_2 \times EQI \quad (2\text{-}2)$$

$$EE/EHI = \beta_0 + \beta_1 PCG + \beta_2 RGP + \ldots + \beta_i X_i + \ldots + \beta_9 ICWUR + \beta_{10} ECPG + \beta_{11} WCPG + \varepsilon_i \quad (2\text{-}3)$$

Table 2.1 ×××××××××××××××× **(**bold, Times New Roman, size 12, single linespace. Paragraph alignment: centered**)**

×××	×××
×××	×××××××××××××××

Table 2.1（continue） ×××××××××××××××× **(**bold, Times New Roman, size 12, single linespace. Paragraph alignment: centered**)**

×××	×××
×××	×××××××××××××××

Chapter 3. Conclusion

(Chapter Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 18)

(main text: Times New Roman, size 12, double linespace. Reference is cited by number in square brackets. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

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References

(The reference list should be placed after the main text, in Times New Roman, size 12, with single line spacing, and start on a new page. Paragraph alignment: fully justified.)

[1] ENGEL P A. Impact Wear of Materials[M]. 2nd ed. New York: Elsevier, 1986. (Published books: should give authors, title of the book, edition, publisher, publish year and the page cited if applicable.)

[2] Hao, Z., AghaKouchak, A., Nakhjiri, N. & Farahmand, A. Global Integrated Drought Monitoring and Prediction System (GIDMaPS) data sets. figshare http://dx.doi.org/10.6084/m9.figshare.853801 (2014). (research datasets: Research datasets may be cited in the reference list if they have been assigned digital object identifiers (DOIs) and include authors, title, publisher (repository name), identifier (DOI expressed as a URL).)

[3] Babichev, S. A., Ries, J. & Lvovsky, A. I. Quantum scissors: teleportation of single-mode optical states by means of a nonlocal single photon. Preprint at http://arXiv.org/quant-ph/0208066 (2002). (Recognized preprints may be cited in the reference list.)

[4] Yu, X., Li, C., Wang, Z., Xu, Y., Shao, S., Shao, F., Wang, H., & Liu, J. Neutrophils in cancer: dual roles through intercellular interactions. *Oncogene*, **2024**, 43(11), 1-15 (published journal papers or conference abstracts: should give authors, article title and journal name as above, followed by URL in full - or DOI if known - and the year of publication in parentheses.)

[5] Lu, Q. et. al. www.bing.com (Websites: should give authors if known, title of cited page, URL in full, and year of posting in parentheses.)

[6] Hilderbran, S., Weissleder, R., and **Shao, F.**, Monofunctional carbocyanine dyes for in vivo and in vitro imaging, US Patent No. WO 2010054330, May, 2010 (numbered patents: should give authors, patent title and patent number and country)

[7] Wang Y., Zhang Q., Qin M., et.al Knowledge-aware Reinforced Language Models for Protein Directed Evolution *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning*, PMLR 235:52260-52273, 2024. (conference paper: should give authors, Title of contribution [Paper presentation]. conference Name, Location, Year, Date. DOI or URL)

Appendix

(if applicable)

You can attach your publication, patent document, etc here.

Author's Biography

(Chapter Title - Bolded, Times New Roman, size 24)

(Main text: Times New Roman, size 12, 1.5 linespace)

1. Personal Information

Name: Cheng Xiaodan

Gender: Female

Date of Birth: 1976-07-23

2. Education

1992.09-1995.07 Hangzhou Xuejun High School

1995.09-1999.07 Zhejiang University, Bachelor's Degree

3. Awards

4. Research Experience

5. Publications and Patents

Appendix VII

ZJU-UIUC INSTITUTE
Zhejiang University-University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Institute
浙江大学伊利诺伊大学厄巴纳香槟校区联合学院

Academic Integrity Commitment of Senior Thesis

1. I solemnly promise that the submitted thesis has been completed under the guidance of my supervisor in strict accordance with the relevant regulations of the university and the college.

2. In my thesis, except for the parts specifically marked and acknowledged, it does not contain research results that have been published or written by others, nor does it contain materials used to obtain degrees or certificates from Zhejiang University or other educational institutions.

3. Any contributions made by my colleagues to this research have been clearly stated and acknowledged in the thesis.

4. I promise that there has been no fabrication of data in the process of completing the thesis.

5. If there is any infringement of intellectual property rights in this thesis, I shall bear the corresponding legal responsibilities.

6. I fully understand that Zhejiang University has the right to retain and submit copies and disks of this thesis to relevant departments or agencies, and to allow the thesis to be consulted and borrowed. I authorize Zhejiang University to include all or part of this thesis in relevant databases for retrieval and dissemination, and to save and compile this thesis by means of photocopying, scanning or abridging.

Author's Signature: Supervisor's Signature:

Date: Date:

Appendix VIII

On-site Minutes of Oral Defense

Project Title					
Student Name:		**ZJU ID**		**Major**	
Supervisor		**Academic Title**			
Co-supervisor		**Academic Title**			
Defense Time		**Defense Location**			
Thesis Committee Members					

Minutes of Oral Defense: (Specific records and evaluations are required for the presentation and answering of questions during the defense)

Name and Signature of minute recorder: Date:	Chairman of thesis committee & Signature: Date:

Appendix IX

Assessment Form of Senior Thesis

Supervisor's comments (more than 50 EN words):	
Supervisor's Signature:	**Date:**
Thesis Committee check the following box: ☐ Agree to oral defense. ☐ Agree to oral defense after revisions. ☐ Does not meet the requirements for oral defense.	
Name & Signature of committee chair:	**Date:**
Comments from Thesis Committee:	

Marking rubrics	**Project Proposal (10%)**	**Mid-term Check (5%)**	**Senior thesis (50%)**	**Oral defense (30 %)**	**Outcome * (5%)**	**Total (max. 100 marks)**
Grades						
Committee Chair's Signature:				**Date:**		
***Outcome: The detail will be announced later.**						

Appendix X

ZJUI Compact on Confidential Control of Senior Thesis

Student's Department (Faculty)_____, Name_____, ID_____, Thesis Title_____, Reason for Confidentiality Application：_____

_____

_____, Applying for the thesis (design) to be classified as confidential, with a retention period of 2 years, From_____ (thesis submission date) To_____.

To maintain the confidentiality of the sensitive content, Party A (Supervisor) and Party B (persons involved with the confidential thesis (design), including the student, reviewers, defense committee members, etc.) agree to the following terms:

(I) During the confidentiality period, the thesis author must comply with the following provisions:

1. Do not take confidential project documents and materials (including paper and electromagnetic media) out of the laboratory privately, do not copy, excerpt, save, or destroy them privately, and do not discuss the confidential content of the project with unrelated personnel.
2. Do not conduct confidential research projects or write confidential theses on networked computers, and all drafts must not be discarded casually; they must be destroyed using a paper shredder.
3. Do not use software other than the university's unified detection platform to test the thesis.
4. If a thesis needs to be published during the confidentiality period of the graduation thesis (design), it must undergo declassification processing.
5. Upon graduation, all confidential materials and items must be handed over to the management department of the student's department (faculty).
6. After graduation, the confidential content must still be kept confidential and must not be disclosed in any form (direct, indirect, oral, or written).

(II) During the confidentiality period, reviewers, defense committee members, and other relevant personnel must comply with the following provisions:

1. After reviewing, return the thesis to Party A.
2. Before the internal secrets they are aware of are declassified, do not disclose the secrets they have access to any unit or individual outside the scope of knowledge in any form (direct, indirect, oral, or written).

If the above commitments are violated and confidential content is leaked, Party B

will bear the corresponding legal responsibility for the leak. For serious cases, legal action will be taken.

This agreement takes effect from the date of signature by both parties and automatically expires upon the declassification of this thesis.

Party A (Supervisor) Signature:

Department (Faculty) Head Signature:

Date:

(Seal)

Party B (Signature):

Date:

Notes:

1. Students, thesis reviewers, defense committee members, and other relevant personnel involved with the confidential thesis (design) can sign the same agreement form.
2. This form is in duplicate, with one copy for the supervisor and one copy for the undergraduate student.
3. This form must not be filled out, printed, emailed, or transmitted on networked computers.